Progress Test 1 — after Lessons 1 to 3

Part 2 of 6: Section 2 — Reading

Level: A2 · checks Lessons 1, 2 and 3

About 25 minutes · this part carries a sheet

Section 2 — Reading (30 marks, about 25 minutes)

Passage: Two Kinds of Memory (241 words)

A computer keeps information in two different places, and the difference between them matters every single day.

The first place is the memory the computer uses while it is working. Programmers call it RAM. When you open a file, the computer copies it into this memory, because this memory is very fast. But it is not safe. [A] When the electricity stops, everything inside it disappears immediately.

The second place is the disk. [B] The disk is slower, but it keeps your files when the machine is off. This is why your teacher tells you to save often. Saving means moving your work from the fast memory to the slow one.

Many students learn this rule the hard way. [C] They write for two hours, the power stops, and the work is gone — not because the computer is broken, but because the work never left the fast memory.

There is a second lesson after the first one. A file on one disk is still a file in one place. [D] If the disk stops working, or the laptop is lost, the file is gone with it. A backup is a copy on a different machine, in a different place.

Good habits are small ones. Save every few minutes. Keep one copy somewhere else. Then, once a month, check that the second copy really opens. Many people make backups for years without ever testing them, and they discover the problem on the worst possible day.

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1. (Factual, 4 marks) What does the computer do when you open a file?

   A. It copies the file into the fast memory.
   B. It sends the file to another machine.
   C. It makes a backup of the file.
   D. It turns the disk off.

2. (Factual, 4 marks) According to the passage, what is the disk good at?

   A. Working very fast.
   B. Keeping files when the machine is off.
   C. Making copies on other machines.
   D. Testing backups once a month.

3. (Negative factual, 4 marks) The writer advises all of the following EXCEPT

A. save every few minutes.

B. keep one copy somewhere else.

C. check that the second copy opens.

D. buy a faster computer.

4. (Vocabulary in context, 4 marks) The word "disappears" in paragraph 2 is closest in meaning to

A. becomes slow.

B. is gone.

C. is copied.

D. is saved.

5. (Reference, 4 marks) In the sentence, if the disk stops working, the file is gone with it, the word "it" refers to

A. the backup.

B. the fast memory.

C. the disk.

D. the copy.

6. (Inference, 4 marks) It can be inferred from the passage that

A. a backup on the same disk is not really a backup.

B. RAM is more useful than a disk.

C. most students never lose their work.

D. testing a backup is a waste of time.

7. (Sentence insertion, 3 marks) Look at the four letters [A] [B] [C] [D] in the passage. Where would this sentence best fit?

> It exists only while the power is on.

- A. At [A]
- B. At [B]
- C. At [C]
- D. At [D]

8. (Purpose of a paragraph, 3 marks) Why does the writer mention students who write for two hours?

A. To show what happens when work never leaves the fast memory.

B. To explain how a disk is built.

C. To show that students work too slowly.

D. To criticise teachers who ask for long essays.